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ANALOGY

PART 4

Alphabet Analogy | Concepts, Patterns, Shortcuts & Examiner's Tricks

Competitive Exams: Punjab Police, Punjab Police SI, PSSSB, Punjab PCS, SSC, Banking, Railways, CDS, CAPF

Introduction

What is Alphabet Analogy?

An **Alphabet Analogy** compares two groups of letters using a specific relationship.

Your task is to identify the relationship in the first pair and apply the **same relationship** to another pair.

Golden Rule for Alphabet Analogy

Always check the relationship in this order:

1. Alphabet Position
2. Forward Movement (+)
3. Backward Movement (–)
4. Equal Shift
5. Alternate Letters
6. Opposite Letters
7. Reverse Order
8. Letter Pattern
9. Vowel–Consonant Pattern
10. Mixed Operations

Tip: Convert every letter into its alphabet position first if the relationship is not obvious.

Alphabet Positions (Most Important)

Letter	Position	Letter	Position
A	1	N	14
B	2	O	15

C	3	P	16
D	4	Q	17
E	5	R	18
F	6	S	19
G	7	T	20
H	8	U	21
I	9	V	22
J	10	W	23
K	11	X	24
L	12	Y	25
M	13	Z	26

Exam Tip: Learn the positions of A–M (1–13) and N–Z (14–26). Most alphabet analogy questions become easier after converting letters into numbers.

Type 1 – Same Forward Shift

Simple Explanation

Every letter moves **forward by the same number**.

Example

AB : CD :: EF : ?

Relationship

Each letter moves **+2**

A → C

B → D

E → G

F → H

Answer → GH

Type 2 – Same Backward Shift

Simple Explanation

Every letter moves **backward by the same number**.

Example

FG : DE :: LM : ?

Relationship

Each letter moves **-2**

L → J

M → K

Answer → JK

Type 3 – Alternate Letter Pattern

Simple Explanation

Letters are skipped in a fixed pattern.

Example

ACE : CEG :: GIK : ?

Relationship

Alternate letters are used.

Follow the same pattern.

Exam Tip

Whenever you notice

A, C, E

or

B, D, F

check **alternate letter movement** first.



Type 4 – Opposite Letter Pattern

Simple Explanation

Letters are replaced by their opposite letters in the English alphabet.

Important Opposite Letter Pairs

Letter	Opposite
A	Z
B	Y
C	X
D	W
E	V
F	U
G	T
H	S
I	R
J	Q
K	P
L	O
M	N

Example

A : Z :: C : ?

Answer

X

Type 5 – Reverse Order

Simple Explanation

The letters are written in reverse order.

Example

ABC : CBA :: DEF : ?

Answer

FED

Type 6 – Position-Based Analogy

Simple Explanation

Questions are based on the numerical positions of letters.

Example

C : 3 :: H : ?

Answer

8

Example

17 : Q :: 20 : ?

Answer

T

Type 7 – Vowel & Consonant Pattern

Simple Explanation

Questions are based on vowels and consonants.

Vowels

A, E, I, O, U

Consonants

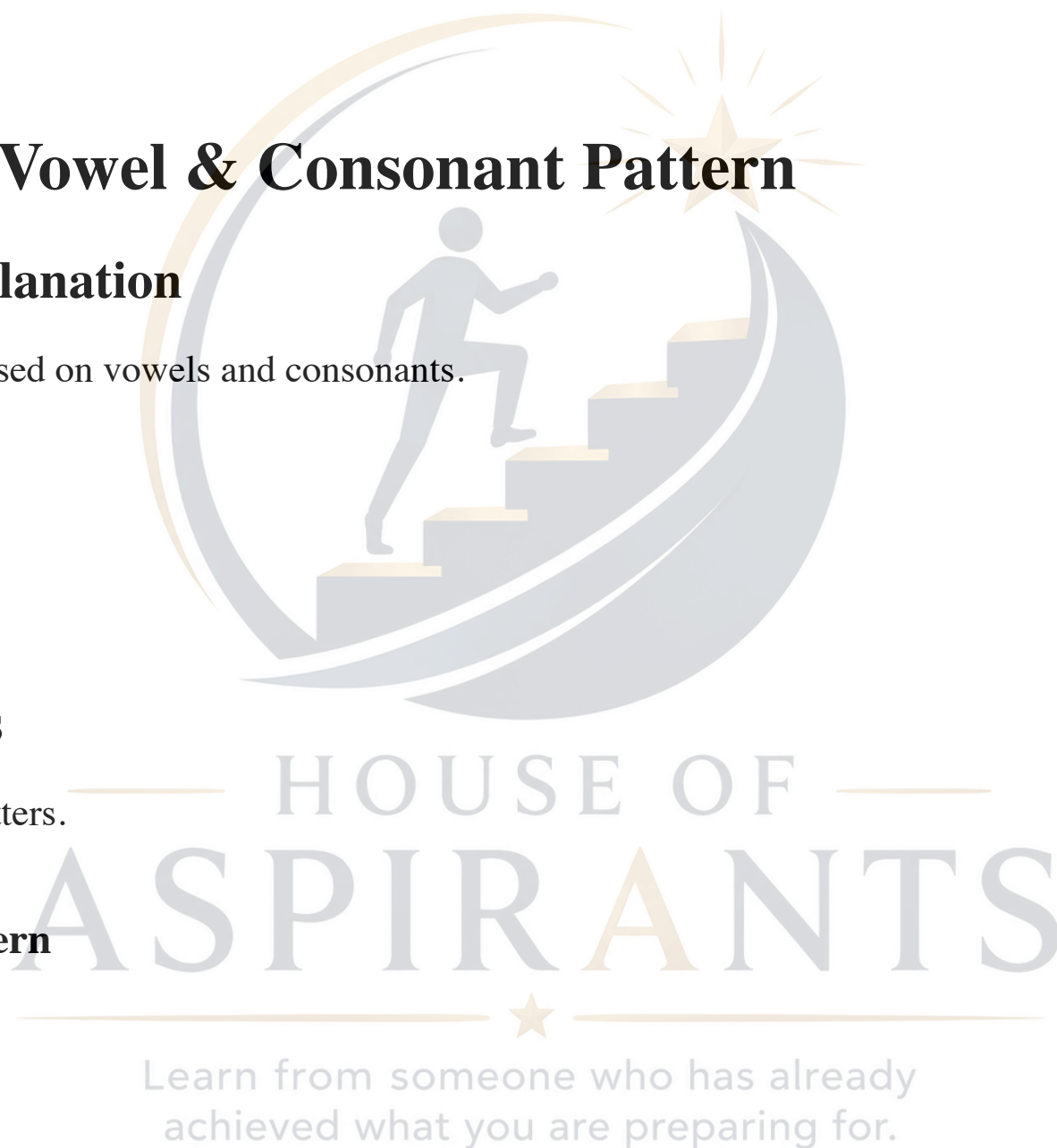
All remaining letters.

Example Pattern

AEIOU

↓

Another vowel sequence



Type 8 – Mixed Operations

Simple Explanation

Different operations are applied to different letters, but the same rule is repeated in the second pair.

Example

First letter $\rightarrow +1$

Second letter $\rightarrow +2$

Third letter $\rightarrow -1$

Apply exactly the same rule to the next group.

How to Solve Alphabet Analogy

Step 1

Write the alphabet positions.

Step 2

Find the movement.

Example

+2

-3

+5

Alternate

Reverse

Step 3

Apply exactly the same movement to the second pair.

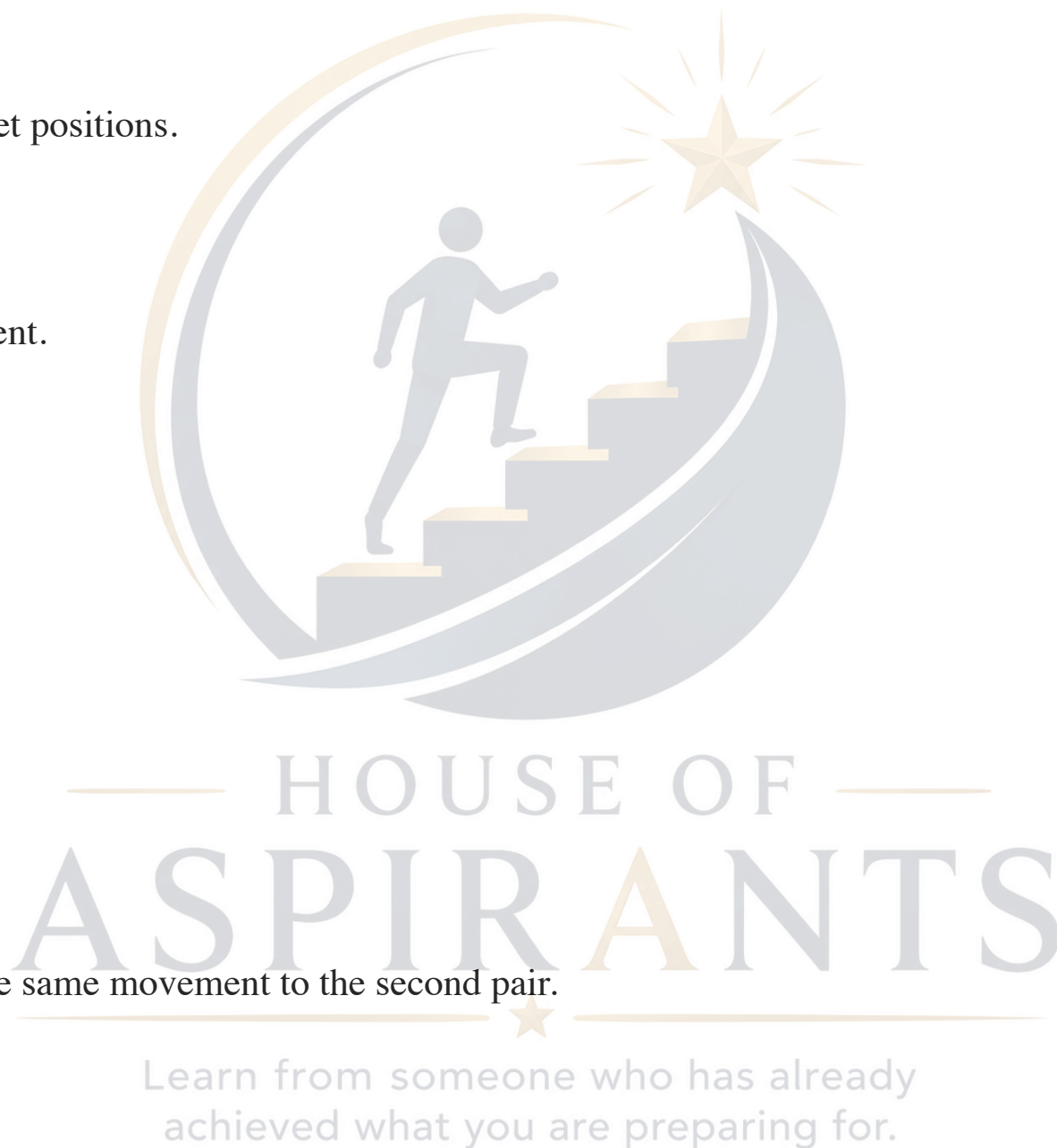
Step 4

Verify every letter.

One incorrect letter means the option is wrong.

Common Mistakes

✗ Looking at words instead of letters.



✗ Ignoring alphabet positions.

✗ Using different rules for different letters.

✗ Forgetting reverse order.

✗ Missing alternate-letter patterns.

Examiner's Tricks

Trick 1

If every letter changes equally,
check **+1, +2, +3** first.

Trick 2

If letters seem random,
convert them into alphabet positions.

Trick 3

If the first letter moves forward,
check whether every other letter also moves by the same value.

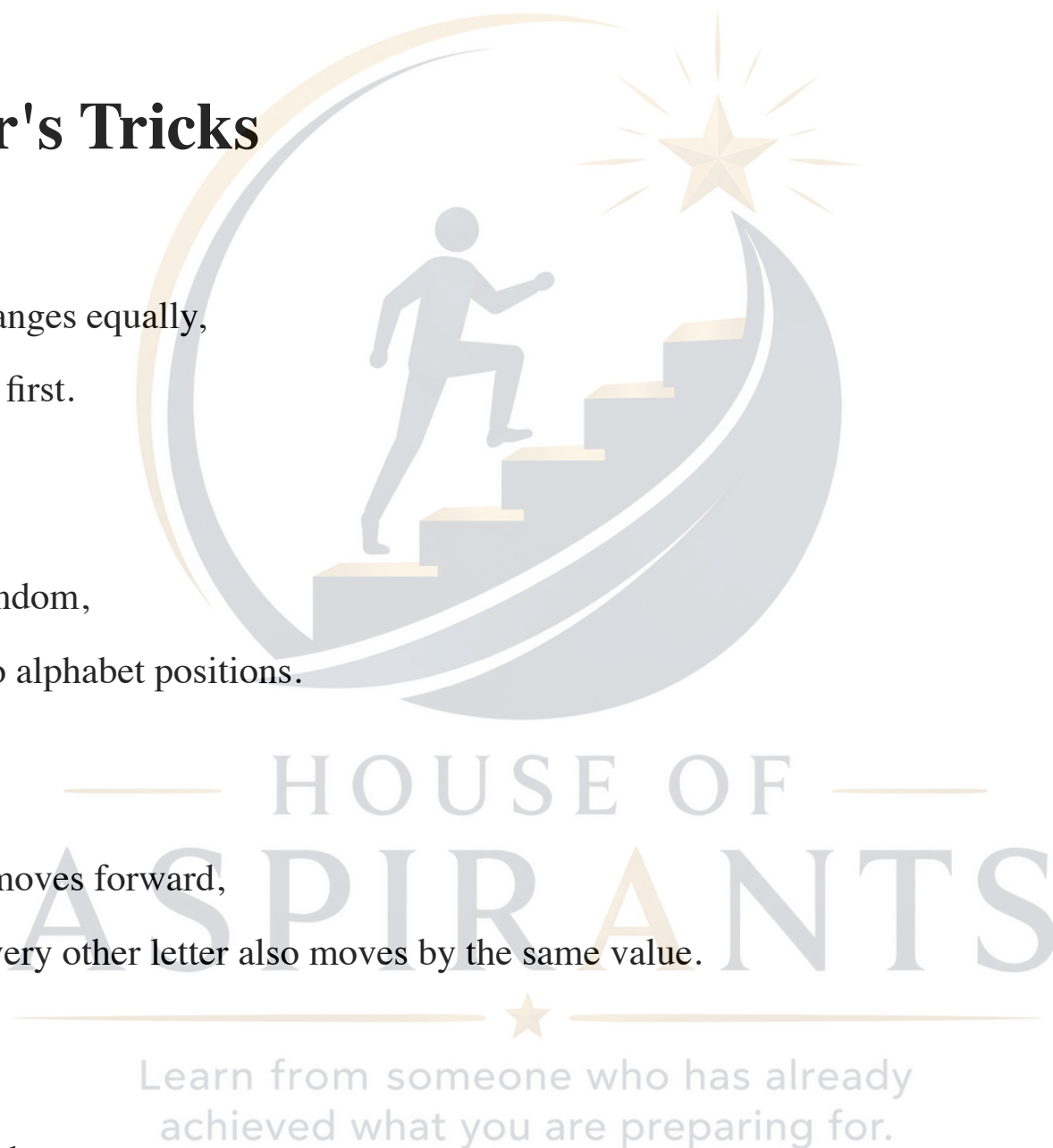
Trick 4

If no pattern matches,
check:

- Reverse order
- Opposite letters
- Alternate letters

Memory Tricks

Alphabet Position



Remember:

A = 1

M = 13

Z = 26

Opposite Letters

A ↔ Z

B ↔ Y

C ↔ X

Vowels

AEIOU

Learn these in order.

Golden Formula

Position → Pattern → Answer

Always follow this sequence.



Quick Revision (2 Minutes)

- A = 1
- M = 13
- Z = 26
- Forward Shift
- Backward Shift
- Alternate Letters
- Reverse Order
- Opposite Letters
- Alphabet Position
- Vowel Pattern
- Consonant Pattern
- Mixed Shift
- A ↔ Z
- B ↔ Y
- C ↔ X
- AEIOU
- Position First

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- Same Rule
- Verify Every Letter
- One Rule for Both Pairs

Master Revision Sheet

Relationship	Example
Country → Capital	India → New Delhi
State → Capital	Punjab → Chandigarh
Country → Currency	India → Rupee
Instrument → Measurement	Thermometer → Temperature
Quantity → Unit	Force → Newton
Individual → Group	Soldier → Army
Animal → Young One	Cow → Calf
Male → Female	Lion → Lioness
Animal → Movement	Duck → Waddle
Animal → Sound	Lion → Roar
Individual → Dwelling Place	Dog → Kennel
Profession → Workplace	Chef → Restaurant
Profession → Person Served	Doctor → Patient
Material → Product	Pulp → Paper
Subject → Studies	Botany → Plants
Part → Whole	Arc → Circle
Game → Place	Tennis → Court
Tool → Requirement	Needle → Thread
Synonym	Vigilant → Alert
Antonym	Giant → Dwarf

Most Repeated Scientific Instruments

Instrument	Measures
Thermometer	Temperature

Hygrometer	Humidity
Ammeter	Electric Current
Barometer	Pressure
Seismograph	Earthquakes
Screw Gauge	Thickness
Sphygmomanometer	Blood Pressure

Most Repeated Units

Quantity	Unit
Force	Newton
Pressure	Pascal
Energy	Joule
Work	Joule
Length	Metre
Mass	Kilogram
Potential	Volt
Area	Hectare

Most Repeated Collective Nouns

Individual	Group
Soldier	Army
Player	Team
Fish	Shoal
Bee	Swarm
Sheep	Flock

Cattle	Herd
Sailor	Crew
Flower	Bouquet

Most Repeated Animal Relationships

Animal	Young One
Cow	Calf
Dog	Puppy
Cat	Kitten
Horse	Foal
Frog	Tadpole
Lion	Cub
Sheep	Lamb

Most Repeated Male–Female Pairs

Male	Female
Lion	Lioness
Horse	Mare
Fox	Vixen
Dog	Bitch
Cock	Hen
Bull	Cow
Stag	Doe

Most Repeated Animal Movements

Animal	Movement
Duck	Waddle
Lion	Prowl

Bird	Fly
Eagle	Swoop
Rabbit	Leap

Most Repeated Sounds

Animal / Thing	Sound
Lion	Roar
Snake	Hiss
Duck	Quack
Frog	Croak
Goat	Bleat
Donkey	Bray
Cock	Crow
Elephant	Trumpet

Most Repeated Dwelling Places

Individual	Dwelling Place
Dog	Kennel
Lion	Den
Bee	Hive
Bird	Nest
Mouse	Hole
Pig	Sty

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Word Analogy – High Frequency Relationships

Relationship	Example
Subject → Study	Botany → Plants
Subject → Study	Entomology → Insects
Profession → Workplace	Chef → Restaurant
Profession → Workplace	Druggist → Pharmacy
Profession → Person	Doctor → Patient

Material → Product	Hemp → Rope
Material → Product	Pulp → Paper
List → Collection	Menu → Food
List → Collection	Catalogue → Books
Game → Place	Tennis → Court

Number Analogy – Checklist

Before answering, check in this order:

1. Addition (+)
2. Subtraction (–)
3. Multiplication (×)
4. Division (÷)
5. Square
6. Cube
7. Square Root
8. Prime Numbers
9. Odd–Even Pattern
10. Difference Pattern



Alphabet Analogy – Checklist

Check the following patterns:

- Alphabet Position
- Forward Shift
- Backward Shift
- Equal Shift
- Alternate Letters
- Reverse Order
- Opposite Letters
- Mixed Pattern



Memory Tricks

Capitals

India → New Delhi

Bangladesh → Dhaka

Currency

China → Yuan

Thailand → Baht

Scientific Instruments

Thermo = Temperature

Hygro = Humidity

Baro = Pressure

Units

Force → Newton

Pressure → Pascal

Energy → Joule

Animals

Dog → Puppy → Kennel

Lion → Cub → Den → Roar

Bee → Swarm → Hive

Word Analogy

Botany → Plants

Doctor → Patient

Chef → Restaurant

Needle → Thread

Number Analogy

$+$ → $-$ → $\times$ → $\div$ → $\square$ → $\sqrt[3]{}$ /Cube → $\sqrt{}$

(Check arithmetic operations in this order.)

Alphabet Analogy

Position → Pattern → Answer



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Exam Day Strategy

- **Step 1:** Identify the relationship in the first pair.
- **Step 2:** Do **not** focus on the meanings of individual words; focus on the relationship.
- **Step 3:** For **Number Analogy**, test operations in the standard order (Addition → Subtraction → Multiplication → Division → Square → Cube → Square Root).
- **Step 4:** For **Alphabet Analogy**, convert letters into alphabet positions whenever the pattern is not immediately visible.
- **Step 5:** Eliminate options that do not follow the exact same relationship.

